

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 20

Group 20 Vocabulary

1. Abreast

Meaning: Up to date with the latest information; side by side.

Tip to remember: Think of people walking side by side and keeping pace. If you are abreast of news, you are keeping pace with it.

Sentence: Students should stay abreast of recent developments in renewable energy.

2. Confound

Meaning: To confuse, puzzle, or surprise someone.

Tip to remember: Confound sounds like “confuse found.” When a problem confounds you, you find confusion.

Sentence: The unexpected result confounded the researchers.

3. Digression

Meaning: A movement away from the main topic.

Tip to remember: Think of a lecture going in a different direction. That side path is a digression.

Sentence: The professor’s digression about history was interesting but unrelated.

4. Discrepancy

Meaning: A difference or inconsistency between two things that should match.

Tip to remember: Think of two exam marks that should be the same but are different. That difference is a discrepancy.

Sentence: The accountant found a discrepancy in the financial report.

5. Duplicious

Meaning: Deceitful or dishonest; pretending one thing while doing another.

Tip to remember: Duplicious contains “dupli,” meaning double. A duplicious person has a double face.

Sentence: His duplicious behavior destroyed the team’s trust.

6. Expedient

Meaning: Convenient and practical, though sometimes morally questionable.

Tip to remember: Expedient sounds like “easy exit.” It is a quick practical solution, but not always the right one.

Sentence: The leader chose an expedient solution instead of a fair one.

7. **Fabricate**
Meaning: To invent or make up something false; to construct.
Tip to remember: Fabricate sounds like making fabric. You can fabricate cloth, but also fabricate lies.
Sentence: The student fabricated data for the lab report.
8. **Glum**
Meaning: Sad, gloomy, or unhappy.
Tip to remember: Glum sounds like gloom. A glum person looks gloomy.
Sentence: He looked glum after receiving the rejection letter.
9. **Harbinger**
Meaning: A sign that something is going to happen.
Tip to remember: Dark clouds are a harbinger of rain. They announce what is coming.
Sentence: Early snowfall was a harbinger of a harsh winter.
10. **Intrinsic**
Meaning: Belonging naturally or essentially to something.
Tip to remember: Intrinsic means “inside nature.” It is built into the thing itself.
Sentence: Curiosity is intrinsic to good research.
11. **Largesse**
Meaning: Generosity in giving money or gifts.
Tip to remember: Largesse sounds like “large gifts.” A generous person gives largesse.
Sentence: The university expanded its scholarship program through the donor’s largesse.
12. **Libertine**
Meaning: A person who behaves without moral restraint, especially in pleasure-seeking.
Tip to remember: Libertine comes from liberty, but it means too much freedom without morality.
Sentence: The novel portrays the prince as a selfish libertine.
13. **Malfeasance**
Meaning: Wrongdoing or illegal behavior, especially by a public official.
Tip to remember: “Mal” means bad, and “feasance” means doing. Malfeasance means bad doing.
Sentence: The mayor was investigated for malfeasance.
14. **Manifest**
Meaning: Clear and obvious; to show or reveal.
Tip to remember: Manifest means something becomes visible to the eyes or mind.
Sentence: Her confidence was manifest during the presentation.

15. **Minute**
Meaning: Extremely small or detailed.
Tip to remember: GRE trick: minute can mean tiny, not only sixty seconds. Pronounced my-NOOT in this meaning.
Sentence: The engineer noticed a minute crack in the component.
16. **Modish**
Meaning: Fashionable or stylish.
Tip to remember: Modish sounds like modern. Something modish follows current fashion.
Sentence: She wore a modish jacket to the conference.
17. **Nascent**
Meaning: Just beginning to develop; newly formed.
Tip to remember: Nascent sounds like “new ascent.” Something nascent is starting to rise.
Sentence: Nepal’s nascent electric vehicle market is growing quickly.
18. **Perennial**
Meaning: Lasting for a long time; recurring again and again.
Tip to remember: Perennial plants return every year. Perennial problems also keep returning.
Sentence: Load shedding was once a perennial problem in Nepal.
19. **Pious**
Meaning: Deeply religious; sometimes pretending to be morally good.
Tip to remember: Think of a person praying sincerely. That person is pious.
Sentence: The pious man visited the temple every morning.
20. **Providential**
Meaning: Happening at a lucky or fortunate time, as if by divine care.
Tip to remember: Providence means divine guidance. Providential help feels like help from fate.
Sentence: The rain was providential for the drought-stricken farmers.
21. **Prowess**
Meaning: Great skill or ability.
Tip to remember: Prowess sounds like “pro.” A professional-level skill is prowess.
Sentence: Her mathematical prowess impressed the selection committee.
22. **Schism**
Meaning: A split or division between groups, especially because of disagreement.
Tip to remember: Schism sounds like “scissor.” Scissors split things into two parts.
Sentence: The argument caused a schism within the organization.
23. **Slander**
Meaning: A false spoken statement that damages someone’s reputation.

Tip to remember: Think of spoken lies that slide into public and harm someone. That is slander.

Sentence: The actor sued the journalist for slander.

24. **Stalwart**

Meaning: Loyal, strong, and dependable.

Tip to remember: Think of a strong wall that never falls. A stalwart supporter stands firm.

Sentence: She was a stalwart supporter of clean energy.

25. **Supplicate**

Meaning: To ask or beg earnestly and humbly.

Tip to remember: Supplicate sounds like “supplication,” a humble prayer.

Sentence: The villagers supplicated the king for help during the famine.

26. **Terse**

Meaning: Brief and direct, sometimes rudely short.

Tip to remember: Terse sounds like “short verse.” It uses very few words.

Sentence: His terse reply made everyone think he was angry.

27. **Tirade**

Meaning: A long, angry speech.

Tip to remember: Think of someone tired of a problem and exploding into a long rant. That is a tirade.

Sentence: The coach launched into a tirade after the team’s poor performance.

28. **Universal**

Meaning: Existing everywhere or applying to everyone.

Tip to remember: Universal comes from universe. If something is universal, it applies across the whole world or universe.

Sentence: The desire for respect is universal.

29. **Vanquish**

Meaning: To defeat completely.

Tip to remember: Vanquish sounds like “finish.” To vanquish an enemy is to finish them completely.

Sentence: The team worked hard to vanquish its strongest rival.

30. **Woeful**

Meaning: Very sad; extremely bad or poor.

Tip to remember: Woe means deep sadness. Woeful means full of woe.

Sentence: The report revealed the woeful condition of the old bridge.